

SSC / UPPSC Exam — Current Affairs Class Notes

Full topic-wise notes of the live current-affairs class, including all MCQs discussed and the end-of-class quick revision points.
Class conducted on September 8, 2026.

1. Class Opening & Announcements

- The class began with a joint solving of the recent **UPPSC Polytechnic exam** General Studies paper.
- SSC CHSL notification** has been released; the exact exam date was not mentioned in the notification. A separate 5–10 minute explainer video (eligibility by age/12th-pass year, sectional timing, etc.) was to be released around 10:00 AM the same day.
- Paid batch lectures resumed from this session onward.

2. Maldives–China–India: Thilafushi Port/Airport

Current news: Maldives has handed the development of a new airport/port project at **Thilafushi Island** to a **Chinese company (China Communications Construction Company)**, reversing an earlier 2024 public announcement that India and Maldives would jointly develop it.

- Maldives — location: Indian Ocean; Capital: **Malé**.
- India's earlier initiative here: **Greater Malé Connectivity Project** — meant to shift airport congestion from crowded Malé to Thilafushi Island.
- China's strategy around India: **String of Pearls** (Silk Route-linked ports encircling India via friendly coastal nations).
- India's counter-strategy: **Necklace of Diamonds** — India's own network of ports/bases around China.
- Sri Lanka's Hambantota Port (developed with Chinese loans, later leased back to China) is cited as a precedent — same Chinese firm has been involved in projects in Kenya, Ghana and Sri Lanka, often followed by debt-driven port takeovers.
- Maldives facts: official language — **Dhivehi**; Parliament — called **Majlis**.
- India–Maldives defence exercise: **Ekuverin**. Trilateral exercise with Sri Lanka: **Dosti** (India, Sri Lanka, Maldives).

Q. A new port/airport project (Thilafushi) recently reported in the news belongs to which country, and which country is now developing it?

Ans: Thilafushi Island belongs to Maldives; the project is now being developed by China.

3. Tribes & Heritage — MCQs

Q. Native place of the Jenu Kuruba tribe?

Ans: Karnataka

Q. Which ruler/dynasty got the Rajarajeswara Temple built at Thanjavur (similar to Brihadeeswara Temple)?

Ans: Raja Raja Chola — Chola dynasty

4. Shekhawati Havelis (Rajasthan) — UNESCO Tentative List

- News: Fresco-adorned havelis of Shekhawati have been placed on UNESCO's **Tentative List** (under the Tangible category); 14 locations/sites in total.
- UNESCO: formed in **1945 (London)**; began functioning **1946**; HQ — **Paris**.
- India in UNESCO's **Tangible list**: 45 sites (latest addition — Sarnath).
- India in the **Intangible list**: 16 items (latest — Diwali/Deepavali).
- Tentative list**: sites nominated/under consideration, count may change.
- Havelis feature courtyards, chandeliers, and **Fresco** (a type of mural painting made using natural pigments — turmeric for yellow, rose petals for red, marigold for orange, etc.) — hence called the "world's largest open-air art gallery".
- Spread across three Rajasthan districts: **Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu**.
- Built in the **15th century** by Rajputs; named after **Rao Shekha**, a Rajput chieftain.

5. Constitutional Amendments — MCQ

Q. Identify the INCORRECTLY matched pair: (A) Sikkim made a full state — 36th Amendment; (B) Items 67–86 added to 9th Schedule — 34th Amendment; (C) Repealing 10th Schedule — 33rd Amendment; (D) Adding 10th Schedule — 35th Amendment.

Ans: Option D is incorrect — the 10th Schedule (Anti-Defection Law) was actually added by the 52nd Amendment (1985), not the 35th.

6. Rat-Hole Mining

Practice of narrow manual mining shafts dug into hills/coal seams, worker sent down a small tunnel to extract coal by hand — associated in this class with **Meghalaya (Cherrapunji region)**.

7. Andaman & Nicobar Islands — New Lieutenant Governor

- President **Droupadi Murmu** appointed **Dinesh Sharma** (former UP Deputy CM) as the new **LG of Andaman & Nicobar Islands**, replacing **D.K. Joshi** (appointed 2017).
- A/N Islands became a **Union Territory in 1956**; LG is appointed by the President (as is a Governor for states); Delhi, Puducherry and Jammu & Kashmir are the only UTs with their own Legislative Assembly.
- Geography: 800+ islands; Andaman (north) and Nicobar (south) separated by the **10° Channel**.
- Great Nicobar Island**; **Pygmalion Point / Indira Point** — India's **southernmost point**, in the Indian Ocean.
- Saddle Peak** — highest peak of Andaman & Nicobar.

- Capital: **Port Blair**, renamed **Sri Vijaya Puram**.
- India's smallest National Park — **Buttons National Park**.
- Tribes found here: **Jarawa, Shompen, Sentinelese**.
- Also notable: Cellular Jail; Duncan Passage.

8. Padmavat — MCQ

Q. Padmavat was written by whom, and when was it completed?

Ans: Written by Malik Muhammad Jayasi; completed during the reign of Sher Shah Suri, in 1540.

9. FIFA World Cup 2026

As discussed in class: Winner — **Spain**; Runner-up — **Argentina**. Lionel Messi announced his retirement from international football after the tournament.

10. Indonesia Volcanic Eruption

- A volcano on an island near Indonesia's **Ring of Fire (Pacific Ocean)** erupted repeatedly, forcing evacuations and closing four airports (ash/smoke/lava). Volcano/island referred to in class: **Anak Krakatau**.
- Region lies between **Sumatra Island** and **Java Island**, separated by the **Sunda Trench**.
- Java Island — capital **Jakarta**.
- Indonesia's upcoming new capital — **Nusantara**, on **East Kalimantan** (Borneo Island) — not yet officially notified; exam answers should still use **Jakarta** as the current capital.
- Key international airport named in the news: **Soekarno–Hatta Airport**.

11. Revolt of 1857 — Matching MCQ

Q. Match the leaders of the Revolt of 1857 with their associated places (incl. Jagdishpur, etc.).

Ans: Option D

12. Polity — Quick MCQs

Q. Article 280 of the Indian Constitution deals with?

Ans: Finance Commission

Q. Which Constitutional Amendment changed the Preamble of the Constitution?

Ans: 42nd Amendment — added the words 'Socialist', 'Secular' and 'Integrity'.

13. Malaysia Haze / Emergency

- Malaysia has declared an emergency as its **Haze Index crossed 519** in **Sarawak state** (on Borneo Island).
- Malaysia — Southeast Asia; capital **Kuala Lumpur** (also HQ of the Badminton World Federation).
- Haze/smog = smoke + fog; caused mainly by **forest fires in Indonesia** (dryness/drought) combined with the regional **"slash-and-burn"** farmland-clearing practice, with smoke drifting into Malaysia.

- Response measure: **cloud seeding** using **silver iodide** to induce artificial rainfall (similar to IIT Kanpur's cloud-seeding trial in Delhi).

14. Geography — Quick MCQs

Q. Kumaon Himalaya (Uttarakhand) region is associated with which rivers?

Ans: Sutlej and Kali rivers (Kali flows through Uttarakhand) — earlier answer of 'Teesta' is incorrect.

Q. In which language is the text Gatha Saptashati written?

Ans: Prakrit

15. 28th Western Zonal Council Meeting

- Held in **Panaji, Goa**; headed by Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** (Home Ministry always heads Zonal Council meetings).
- Zonal Councils are **advisory bodies** (statutory, not constitutional), set up under the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**.
- Western Zone members: **Maharashtra, Goa, Gujarat, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu**.
- Total Zonal Councils: **5** (North, South, West, Central, East) + **North Eastern Council** (newest, set up under the 1971 Act, functional from 1972) = **6** in all.

16. Indus Water Treaty — MCQ

Q. Which river's water under the Indus Water Treaty is NOT allocated to India?

Ans: Chenab — along with Indus & Jhelum, ~80% of their water goes to Pakistan; Sutlej, Beas and Ravi are the rivers where ~80% of the water goes to India.

17. Birkbeck, University of London — Bengaluru Campus

- UGC has approved **Birkbeck, University of London** to open a campus in **Bengaluru** (UG & PG programmes), under the **Foreign Higher Educational Institutions Regulations**.
- Expected to cost roughly 60% less than studying in the UK.
- Bengaluru — known as the Garden City, Silicon Valley of India, and Space City (ISRO); also home to the **Indian Institute of Science (IISc)**.

18. Supreme Court — EVM / Totalizer Machines

- Supreme Court set up a **3-judge bench** headed by **Justice Surya Kant** to examine EVM-related disputes and recommended introducing **Totalizer machines** for counting.
- A Totalizer aggregates and counts votes from **14 EVMs together**, to reduce disputes over individual machine counting.

- Developed by **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)** and **Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL)**, Hyderabad.
- Election Commission of India — constitutional body under **Article 324**; a multi-member body currently headed by **Gyanesh Kumar**.

19. Sports Round-up

- **Badminton: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty** became the first Indian pair to win the **China Masters/China Open** title, beating China's He Jiting & Ren Xiangyu in a 70-minute final in **Shenzhen, China** (concluded 6 September). They also won the **Singapore Open** earlier this season — a first as well. The pair had won silver at this China event in 2023 and 2025; this is their first gold here.
- **Asian Games** to be held in **Japan**, starting **19 September**.
- **Chess**: A 4-year-old girl from **Odisha** became the **youngest player ever to receive a FIDE rating** (as named in class).
- **Suzuki Cup (cricket, T20 format)** — first-ever **India vs Japan** match scheduled for **21 September**, coinciding with **75 years of India–Japan diplomatic relations**.

20. 18th BRICS Summit

- To be hosted by **India** on **12–13 September**, at **Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi**.
- 10 member countries participate (4 founding + South Africa + later additions); host of the next edition will be decided at this summit.
- Theme: **"Building Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."**

21. End-of-Class Quick Revision

- **Miss World 2026** — won by a contestant from the **Dominican Republic** (the country's 2nd Miss World title); Dominican Republic had earlier conferred its highest civilian award on PM Modi.
- **OpenAI** launched a new AI model (named in class as 'Astra') aimed at tackling **cybercrime**.
- A newly discovered **"Devil Flower"** (named for its scary face-like bloom) found in **Thailand**.
- **UNEP report** released on rising global (Earth's) temperature trends.
- **Cassandra Wilson**, US jazz vocalist and two-time **Grammy** winner, passed away.
- A **21-member Joint Parliamentary Committee**, headed by **Sanjay Jaiswal**, formed to review the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA)**.
- **36th Ig Nobel Prize** announced in **Zurich**; no Indian winners this year.
- **Sri Aurobindo** virtual/AR museum opened in **Auroville, Puducherry** (UT since 1954).

- India won **9 medals** at the **International Earth Science Olympiad**.
- India–Japan **Exercise Veer Guardian** held in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**.
- Today (class day) is also **International Literacy Day**.

22. Complete MCQ Bank (All Current-Affairs MCQs From Class)

1. Thilafushi Island/Port project — whose is the island, and who is now developing the project?

Ans: Island belongs to Maldives; development now handed to China.

2. Native place of the Jenu Kuruba tribe?

Ans: Karnataka

3. Rajarajeswara Temple, Thanjavur, was built under which ruler/dynasty?

Ans: Raja Raja Chola (Chola dynasty)

4. Which pair is INCORRECTLY matched — Sikkim/36th Amdt.; 9th Schedule items 67–86/34th Amdt.; Repeal of 10th Schedule/33rd Amdt.; Addition of 10th Schedule/35th Amdt.?

Ans: Option D — 10th Schedule was actually added by the 52nd Amendment (1985).

5. Which place is associated with rat-hole mining?

Ans: Meghalaya (Cherrapunji region)

6. Who was appointed the new Lieutenant Governor of Andaman & Nicobar Islands?

Ans: Dinesh Sharma

7. Padmavat — author and year of completion?

Ans: Malik Muhammad Jayasi; completed 1540 under Sher Shah Suri.

8. FIFA World Cup 2026 — winner and runner-up?

Ans: Winner: Spain; Runner-up: Argentina.

9. Where is the recent volcanic eruption causing evacuations/airport closures?

Ans: Indonesia (Anak Krakatau, Ring of Fire)

10. Match the Revolt of 1857 leaders with their places (incl. Jagdishpur).

Ans: Option D

11. Article 280 of the Constitution relates to?

Ans: Finance Commission

12. Malaysia's Haze Index crossed which figure, and in which state?

Ans: 519, in Sarawak

13. Kumaon Himalaya region is linked with which rivers?

Ans: Sutlej and Kali

14. Gatha Saptashati is composed in which language?

Ans: Prakrit

15. 28th Western Zonal Council meeting was held where, headed by whom?

Ans: Panaji, Goa; headed by Amit Shah

16. Under the Indus Water Treaty, which river's water is NOT allocated to India?

Ans: Chenab

17. Which Amendment changed the Preamble of the Constitution?

Ans: 42nd Amendment

18. Birkbeck, University of London's new India campus (UGC-approved) will open in which city?

Ans: Bengaluru

19. Supreme Court's EVM/Totalizer bench was headed by which judge?

Ans: Justice Surya Kant

20. Who developed the Totalizer machine for EVM counting?

Ans: Bharat Electronics Ltd. & Electronics Corporation of India Ltd.

21. Which Indian pair won the China Masters/China Open badminton title for the first time?

Ans: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty

22. Next Asian Games will be held in which country, from what date?

Ans: Japan, from 19 September

23. India vs Japan's first-ever Suzuki Cup cricket match (T20) is scheduled on?

Ans: 21 September (75 years of India–Japan relations)

24. 18th BRICS Summit 2026 — host city and theme?

Ans: New Delhi (Bharat Mandapam); Theme: "Building Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"